

own skills, their own hands to solve problems. The maker movement has provided an alternative to relying on mass produced products and large scale companies who control them. Now a person has the freedom to realise his own power by choosing to be self sufficient and working towards it.

And where an individual's hands are failing, the communities are taking up the task of making. This community is not formed on the basis of anything but the act of making, hence they are usually a diverse mix of people from all strata of the society. A maker space is a community of makers gathering together to showcase their work and share their knowledge, in turn solving each other's problems as a group. An entire community gaining a certain skill leads to growth of local businesses and craftsmanship, and brings the individual makers together to function as a team. This is where DIY (Do It Yourself) changes to DIWO (Do It With Others).

This impact is not just restricted to technology and the act of making. A community that gets familiarised with bringing about change from within and solving their own problems no longer waits for institutionalised reforms. People start believing that they have the ability to solve their own problems together. This can only lead to a stronger community as a whole. But as of now, the makers exist in the margins of the society. Just like artists, they consider themselves separate from the mainstream. Although, as we know from human history, the situation wasn't always like this.

The culture question

Historically, there have been periods when there was a massive uprising of innovation and creativity from individuals. The Renaissance, from 14th to the early 17th century, saw a technological upheaval that drastically changed the world. From the printing press to the musket, to Leonardo da Vinci's famous sketchbook with concepts that were way beyond their time, most of these were works of individuals. Then the Industrial revolution was brought about by the trio of James Watt's Steam Engine, Edmund Cartwright's power loom and Henry Cort's Rolling and Puddling iron making processes. The internet as we know it was itself brought about by Tim Berners-Lee in 1989 when he proposed the concept and in 1990 and wrote the first web browser.

All these events gave rise to new cultural aspects that the society welcomed with open arms. Inventors and artists were at the centre of society during such periods, which were defined by unparalleled depth and richness in science, art and culture across the world. Although initially any act of innovation or